

Kay Hales, PhD

Division of Natural Science and Mathematics
Data Analytics Program
Transylvania University

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EDUCATION

- Ph.D. Political Science, University of Kentucky, 2025
Dissertation: *LGBT People's Sense of Linked Fate: Belonging and Utility*
- M.A. Political Science, University of Kentucky, 2023
- B.S. Political Science *summa cum laude*, Louisiana Tech University, 2016

APPOINTMENTS

- 2025– Transylvania University, Division of Math and Natural Sciences; Division of Social Science
Bingham Postdoctoral Teacher-Scholar

PUBLICATIONS

Journal Articles

- 2026 Hales, K. "A Qualitative Approach to Understanding LGBT People's Sense of Linked Fate." *Sexuality Research and Social Policy*. doi:10.1007/s13178-025-01267-5
- 2026 Riggle, E.D.B., Clements, K., Hales, K., Galupo, P. "Contextualizing Personal Pronoun Use in the LGBTQ+ Community: They, She, He." *Psychology of Sexual Orientation and Gender Diversity*. Forthcoming.
- 2025 Hales, K. & Riggle, E.D.B. "One LGBT Community or Many? Linked Fate in LGBT People." *Analyses of Social Issues and Public Policy*. 25(2), e70024. doi:10.1111/asap.70024

Manuscripts Under Review

- 2026 Hales, K. & Riggle, E.D.B. "Scale Development and Validation of the LGBTQ Linked Fate (LGBTQ-LF) Scale." *invited to revise and resubmit*
- 2026 Hales, K. "Modeling Heterogeneity in Sparse Groups with Bayesian Multilevel Inference using Compositionally Adjusted Borrowing."
- 2026 Hales, K. "Internalized stigma and identity affirmation as pathways to LGBTQ people's sense of linked fate."

Working Papers

- 2026 Hales, K. "Conservative, but not a Republican: The Ideology-Partisan Link in LGBTQ+ People."
- 2026 Hales, K. "Substance-Specific Spatial Patterns of Overdose Mortality and Non-Fatal Hospitalizations in Kentucky Counties: Evidence from BYM2 Models"
- 2026 Hales, K. "Who Governs? The Relationship Between LGB People's Political Power and Transgender Rights."

Reports and Technical Documentation

2025– Hales, K. “Pitch Tracking and Player Evaluation Analytics System.” *Transylvania University Baseball Program*.

Designed and maintained a reproducible analytics system in R integrating game and bullpen session data across inconsistent file schemas, with automated deduplication, name standardization, and correction logging. The system generates individual pitcher scouting reports (release point analysis, movement profiles, spin efficiency, within-game fatigue tracking) and batter evaluation reports (contact quality metrics, plate discipline, zone-based swing decisions) as interactive Quarto deliverables for coaching staff. Used for recruitment evaluation, player development, and in-game decision-making.

COURSES TAUGHT

Transylvania University

LGBTQ+ Politics (Fall 2025)

Behavior, Bias, and Identity (Winter 2026)

Data Analytics and Statistics (Audit, Co-Taught Winter 2026)

Political Psychology (Fall 2026)

Data Collection and Evaluation (Fall 2026)

Data Acquisition, Visualization, and Wrangling (Fall 2026)

Applied Data Analytics in Criminology (Winter 2027)

Sports Analytics (May 2027, co-teaching)

Introduction to Epidemiology (Winter 2027, co-teaching)

University of Kentucky

Politics of Law and Courts

Behavior, Identity, and Bias

Introduction to Comparative Politics

Film in Politics

Introduction to American Politics

Comparative Political Institutions

CONFERENCE ACTIVITY

Discussant and Panel Chair

2025 LGBTQ+ Identity and Political Behavior Panel. Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, IL.

2024 New Frontiers in LGBTQ+ Politics. Southern Political Science Association, New Orleans, LA.

Conference Papers Presented

2026 Levan, M. & Hales, K. “Creating Student Opportunities and Encouraging Student Interest Using Sports Analytics” Mathematical Association of America MathFest, Boston, MA.

2025 Riggle, E., Clements, Z., Hales, K., & Galupo, P. “Contextualizing Personal Pronoun Use in the LGBTQ+ Community: They, She, He.” American Psychological Association, Denver, CO.

- 2025 Hales, K. "Internalized Stigma, Externalized Stigma, and LGBTQ People's Sense of Linked Fate: A Multiple Parallel Mediation Model." American Political Science Association, Vancouver, BC, Canada.
- 2025 Hales, K. "Predictive Validity, Measurement Invariance, and Discriminant Validity of the LGBT Linked Fate Scale." Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, IL.
- 2025 Hales, K. "Scale Development and Validation of the LGBT Linked Fate Scale." Southern Political Science Association, San Jose, PR.
- 2025 Hales, K. "Modeling Small-Area Estimates of White Identity through Bayesian Multilevel Modeling with Variational Approximation." APSA State Politics and Policy Conference, Richmond, VA.
- 2024 Hales, K. "LGBT Community or LGBT Subgroups? Linked Fate in LGBT People." Southern Political Science Association, New Orleans, LA.
- 2024 Masterson, J., Wu, J., and Hales, K. "The Past and Future: Determinants of the Presidential Election." Southern Political Science Association, New Orleans, LA.
- 2024 Hales, K. "A Phenomenological Approach to Linked Fate in LGBT People." Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, IL.
- 2023 Hales, K. "Representing the Advantaged: State Legislators' Responsiveness to White Identity." Kentucky Political Science Association, Bowling Green, KY.
- 2023 Hales, K. "Republican Electoral Success and Macro-Level Identity Politics." Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, IL.
- 2022 Hales, K. "White Identity in the 2020 Election: Declining Salience or Variant Prototype?" Kentucky Political Science Association, Lexington, KY.
- 2021 Hales, K. "Racial Resentment, White Identity, and Stereotypical Beliefs in U.S. Presidential Elections." Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, IL.

GRANTS AND FUNDING

- 2026 Grant Allocation Committee (GAC), Transylvania University. "Predictors of Queer Political Identification." Student research grant.
- 2026 Grant Allocation Committee (GAC), Transylvania University. "Gender Perception in Machine Learning: Evaluating CLIP's Representations of Masculinity and Femininity."
- 2026 Grant Allocation Committee (GAC), Transylvania University. "Configurations of Internalized Stigma, Identity Pride, and Disidentification for LGBTQ People's Linked Fate."

AWARDS AND HONORS

- 2024 Office for Policy Studies on Violence Against Women Graduate Fellowship. University of Kentucky, College of Arts and Sciences.
- 2024 Crum Emerging Scholar in American Politics. University of Kentucky, Department of Political Science.
- 2024 Ken Griffin Graduate Research Fund. University of Kentucky, Department of Political Science.
- 2024 Coleman, Gorman, and Miller Graduate Summer Fellowship. University of Kentucky, Department of Political Science.
- 2024 Endowed Doctoral Research and Travel Fund. University of Kentucky, Department of Political Science.
- 2023 Coleman, Gorman, and Miller Graduate Summer Fellowship. University of Kentucky, Department of Political Science.

- 2023 Endowed Doctoral Research and Travel Fund. University of Kentucky, Department of Political Science.
- 2022 Endowed Doctoral Research and Travel Fund. University of Kentucky, Department of Political Science.
- 2020–23 Emerging Scholar Research Fund. University of Kentucky, Department of Political Science.

WORKSHOPS AND INSTRUCTIONAL LABS

- 2026 “Data Analysis and Public Health: How data can inform state-level drug policy in Kentucky” Substance Abuse and KY, Health and Exercise Science, Transylvania University.
- 2026 “Epidemiology Lab Series: Data Analysis in R.” Six-week instructional lab series, Epidemiology, Health and Exercise Science, Transylvania University.
- 2026 “Causal Inference, Panel Data, and Multi-Way Fixed Effects in R.” Multi-session workshop, Econometrics, Economics, Transylvania University. Covered two-way fixed effects, difference-in-differences, and synthetic control methods; evaluated student project designs for causal identification.
- 2025 “Data Analysis in Judicial Research.” Two-day workshop, Legal Systems, Political Science, Transylvania University. Worked through student final project proposals in R and Python.
- 2025 “Populations, Samples, Reliability, and Validity in R.” Two-session workshop, Research Methods, Psychology, Transylvania University. Led to two students initiating summer research on LGBTQ+ politics and health.
- 2025 “Developments in Survey Research and Latent Variable Measurement; LGBTQ+ Research in Political Science.” Two-session workshop, Political Analysis, Political Science, Transylvania University.

INVITED GUEST LECTURES

- 2026 “Using R for Survey Research.” Research Methods, Psychology, Transylvania University.
- 2026 “Survey and Interview Design.” Religious Ethics, Religious Studies, Transylvania University.
- 2026 “LGBTQ+ Identity and Place Attachment in Rural Contexts.” Rural Sociology, Transylvania University.
- 2026 “Biomechanical Inference from Pitch Tracking Data.” Biomechanics, Health and Exercise Science, Transylvania University.
- 2026 “Translating Data into Practitioner Decisions.” Senior Seminar, Health and Exercise Science, Transylvania University.
- 2025 “Evaluating LGBTQ+ Attitudes and Behaviors with Large-N Surveys.” Feminist Research Methods, Women, Gender, and Sexuality Studies, Transylvania University.
- 2025 “Why Data Analytics Needs Humanities Students.” Race and Religion, Religious Studies, Transylvania University.

SERVICE

- 2026 Premiere Mock Class Demonstration, Student Recruitment, Transylvania University
- 2025– Sports Analytics Consulting, Transylvania University Baseball Program
- 2025– ICPSR Official Representative, Transylvania University

MEMBERSHIPS

American Political Science Association

American Political Science Association LGBTQ Caucus

American Psychological Association

Southern Political Science Association

Midwest Political Science Association

Society for Political Methodology

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